

click! Window managers also provide menu(s) for launching applications. Of course, different managers place the menus in different places and organise them differently. That's why we keep saying, "learn the commands"!

4.1.3 Desktop environments

A Desktop Environment is a collection of X clients, including the Window Manager(s). It includes various applications and a collection system tools for the user. The system tools are, more often than not, a GUI for existing commands. This makes learning system management easy for new users. In a way, the Environment can be viewed as an extension of the window manager, just with applications bundled along. The two most commonly used Environments are KDE and GNOME. You may come across Linux enthusiasts arguing about which is better. Well, some people like hockey and some like football. Both KDE and GNOME come with a good set of applications such as office suites, file browsers, multi media players, etc.

If you speak to hardcore Linux fans about desktop environments, you will probably hear them bashing both KDE and GNOME! This is because, as they will tell you (rightly so), desktop environments are huge memory hogs. Besides, everything can be done from the terminal itself, so why use a desktop environment? Well, it's for the beginner—desktop environments let beginners get used to the feel of Linux, while gradually letting them move on to controlling all tasks through the command prompt.

One difference between KDE and GNOME, however, is that it is relatively easier to install different window managers on GNOME than on KDE. This is because GNOME inherently relies on external download managers while KDE has its own download manager.

4.1.3.1 The K Desktop Environment

The KDE project, officially announced on 14th October 1996, is an open group of developers from all over the world. Today, KDE is one of the two most commonly used desktop environments in